

// body recode

The Stress-Stored Reset

The Stress-Stored Reset (mini)

01 A 5-step cortisol wind-down for the body that stores under stress

If your fat holds under load and you're wired at night, your cortisol rhythm is likely running the show. You can't out-train a rhythm - but you can reset it. Here are five steps that start tonight.

1. Anchor the morning

Eat within 60 minutes of waking. This anchors the cortisol curve so it peaks in the morning, where it should, instead of at night.

2. Front-load the demand

Do the hard, stressful things earlier in the day. A body already high in cortisol doesn't need a 7pm spike on top.

3. Build a hard stop

One fixed cue that ends the workday - a walk, a shower, a change of clothes. The body needs a signal that the threat is over.

4. Dim and wind down

Lower the light 60 to 90 minutes before bed. Light is a cortisol input; darkness lets melatonin rise and cortisol fall.

5. Protect the bookends of sleep

No screens in the last hour before bed, no phone in the first hour after waking. The start and end of sleep do the most repair.

Do these for a week and most people feel the wired-at-night feeling ease first - before anything shows on the scale. That's the state starting to shift.

This is the *mini* version. The full **Sleep Reset Protocol** goes deeper on the whole rhythm (link in bio).

Want to know if Stress-Stored is your pattern? The free 2-minute scorecard reads it:
bodyrecode.au/scorecard